

Winter 2026/27 dossiers

One object per page: a scene, a thesis, the published specs, the insight that is not on the brochure, what you would remember, what it costs the rest of the degree. Catalogue lives in the primer. This pack owns the fork.

Enrol in LINK-S before 4 September 2026, 23:59, unless you have written that first-ness beats family-and-credits. Chile is a landscape craving, not a TFAS product. Do not spend SSE. Confirm HKUWW criterion 3 in writing.

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00 · How to hold a winter

Experience is what the days are made of. Meaning is whether those days become a thesis you can still use in April. Memory is a smell, a dark street, a person, a room. NEWDAY scored high on all three because the *form* did the work: a house, a table, a landscape, an argument that was allowed to last nine days. Winter 2026/27 cannot repurchase that form. Nansen has no winter equivalent. NEWDAY 2027 is unpublished.

The degree already has a world-not-seen budget. October 2026 is London (Laidlaw) and Valencia (GEST). Summer 2027 is a Laidlaw LiA with makesense in Medellín or Mexico City. 2027/28 may be an HKUWW year. A later summer may be NEWDAY again, if they run it. Winter 2026/27 is the last block that can still be **China-family time with HKU credits attached** before those international blocks stack. First-ness spent here is first-ness taken from a slot that cannot be replenished as a grandmother. First-ness deferred to LiA or HKUWW is first-ness that still happens.

Chile is a special case of the same physics. The Andes in January are not Medellín in June. LiA does not scratch a Chile craving. TFAS does not scratch a landscape craving. Those are three different objects. Sheet 09 and sheet 10 exist because wanting Chile is allowed, and because wanting Chile is not the same as enrolling in a classical-liberal seminar in Providencia.

Default, still: enrol in LINK-S before 4 September 2026, 23:59, unless you write down — in a sentence you would still sign in April — that first-ness this winter beats family-and-credits. Add/drop still exists after you enrol. Missing 4 September does not.

Last line: Credits are a poor way to choose a grandmother. First-ness is a poor way to refuse one.

01 · The fork

Stamp: DECISION

Window: 24 Dec 2026 – 17 Jan 2027. Sem 1 assessment 7–23 Dec 2026. Sem 2 teaching 18 Jan 2027.

Hard close: LINK Round 2, 4 Sep 2026, 23:59.

SCENE

A kitchen in Shanghai in late December: extractor fan, wet cold that never quite becomes snow, a grandparent who will not say how long the visit is allowed to last. Against it, a garden in Lillehammer last summer where, if the weather permitted, you sat talking around a campfire in light that refused to die. Against both, a PDF from IAO last updated 21 May 2026, “solely intended as a reference,” of winter schools that mostly begin after your second semester has already started.

THESIS

High NEWDAY-likeness and high calendar-fit do not occur together on this list. That is the finding. The decision is which good to take, not which brochure to believe.

THE THREE LIVE GOODS

IF YOU MAXIMISE	TAKE	WHAT YOU ARE ACTUALLY BUYING
Family + 12 HKU credits + dates	LINK-S	Intergenerational maintenance in a city that is already yours, plus a project sprint assessed 55% on delivery
First-Korea that fits	Hanyang Session A	A professional SKY winter campus, 26 Dec – 9 Jan. Edutainment. Replaceable later
Small-Europe first-ness that fits	Vilnius language	Fifty hours of Lithuanian in Baltic dark. Meaning near zero. Memory high
GHD classroom in a city you have already tagged	HUWISU Term 1	January Berlin that is not October Berlin. Self-housing. A return

Tübingen is the cousin. Lille is the package. Their dates lose. Chile/TFAS is a craving with a product attached; the product is the wrong object (sheet 09).

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

IAO’s list is a memory of where HKU students have been, not an offer. LINK is not on it. Comparing LINK-S to Yonsei is comparing a home-course field component to a host credit mill. Different species. The 4.09 GPA is not at risk from LINK (pass/fail, GPA-exempt). It is at risk from missing Sem 2 to chase a cousin. SSE is once per undergraduate, irrespective of amount — do not spend it here. Tung & Ngai’s HK\$80,000 shared cap is not assumed to pay LINK. Whether LINK satisfies compulsory Mainland is **UNVERIFIED** until AASO/the Foundation write it; a Chicago-shaped HKUWW year can depend on that sentence.

VERDICT

Enrol in LINK-S this fortnight. Keep Hanyang A / Vilnius / HUWISU Term 1 as named alternates only if you choose first-ness in writing. Keep Tübingen as the named cousin if SPH ever writes that missing 18–29 Jan is acceptable. It has not. Do not wait for a winter NEWDAY.

OPEN QUESTION

Will you still want first-ness this winter after London and Valencia have already happened in October?

Last line: The winter you loved was a campfire in a country that stays light at midnight. The winter you can actually have is a grey month that will be gone before you have finished naming it.

02 · NEWDAY · calibration (not a winter option)

Stamp: GOLD STANDARD

Official 2026: 29 Jul – 6 Aug 2026 · 9 days · Nansen Academy, Lillehammer

2027: unpublished

Winter equivalent: none

Money (2026, published): NOK 11,000 double / 15,000 single — programme, excursions, food, lodging. Travel extra.

Organisers named on the live page: Chunrong Liu; Daniel Bell (University of Hong Kong); Geir Helgesen; Unn Irene Aasdalen

Page: <https://nansenskolen.no/kurset/newday/> ([nansen.no](https://nansenskolen.no) TLS failed this access)

SCENE

If the weather permits, a campfire in the garden of a folk high school in a Gudbrandsdalen town of about 25,000 people, in light that in late July runs about seventeen hours. Two Nobel houses in the vicinity: Sigrid Undset's Bjerkebæk, Bjørnstjerne Bjørnson's Aulestad. Dialogue groups. East Asia and the Nordics at one table. No HKU credits. No demo day.

THESIS

You did not love Norway. You loved a *form*: small, residential, dialogic, landscape as faculty, nine days allowed to be nine days. Winter shopping that ignores that sentence will produce a correct credit and a wrong month.

SPECS (QUOTED FROM THE 2026 PAGE, ACCESSED 22 AUG 2026)

We offer lectures, discussions, socializing, workshops and excursions.

There will be workshops and dialogue groups, addressing current affairs. In addition, museum visits and walks in the serenity of the surrounding Norwegian nature.

If the weather permits, we will sit talking around the campfire in the light summer nights in the garden of Nansen Academy.

Admissions for 2026 ran from 20 January 2026 until full. That is a **pattern**, not a 2027 date. The other Nansen courses are art, writing, music, an Olympic academy — not East–West dialogue. The folk-high-school *årsplan* for 2027/28 “will come in the course of October 2026”; that is the one-year Norwegian programme, not NEWDAY.

Lillehammer in January (for calibration only): 1991–2020 January mean about **−6.1 °C**, ~28 hours of measured sunshine, calculated daylight around six and a half hours. That is the winter the ski jumps were built for. NEWDAY is not that season.

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

Your own NEWDAY essay already named the thesis: sustain a dialogue rather than win an argument; medical ethics as a grammar when political language fails; Nordic consensus against East Asian pace. A SKY winter school can photocopy “international cohort.” It cannot photocopy that sentence. Residential + small + woods is the DNA. Hotel twins in Lille, club activities in Seoul, and a Providencia hotel with a campus bus are other animals that have learned to wear the word *programme*.

WHAT IT COSTS THE REST OF THE DEGREE

Nothing, this winter: you cannot buy it. The cost is the shopping time you will waste if you keep waiting. Watch from January 2027. Do not invent an opening date. Do not skip LINK-S because a 2027 page might appear.

VERDICT

Calibration only. Not a winter plan. If 2027 runs in summer, it competes with rest, internships, and whatever LiA recovery looks like — a later problem. Stars, as a winter option: experience — / meaning — / memory — / fit **0** / NEWDAY **5**.

OPEN QUESTION

When the 2027 page exists, will you still want nine days in a house more than you want another credential?

Last line: The gold standard remains in another season. Stop auditioning January for a job July already did.

03 · LINK-S · Shanghai

Stamp: ENROL (default)

Official name: Leadership and Innovation Network for Knowledge — LINK-S

Immersion: 27 Dec 2026 – 16 Jan 2027 · lectures Sept–Dec 2026

Credits: 12 HKU, ~240 hours, pass/fail, **GPA-exempt** (credits and pass/fail show; not in GPA or honours)

Weights: participation 15% · execution/delivery 55% · portfolio 30% · lectures 24h + on-site 100h

Money (published): HK\$5,000 to each student (MicroBit Holding Limited). High achievers who have completed and passed: MicroBit Scholarship HK\$10,000. Major costs “covered” — residual flights/insurance **UNVERIFIED**.

Enrol: Round 2 15 Aug – 4 Sep 2026 (23:59) via Google Form. Semester cap 36 credits.

NEWDAY-likeness: 1.5 · **Fit:** 5 · **Meaning:** 4.5 · **Memory:** 4

SCENE

Not a winter school. A project you have been building since September, executed in a three-week sprint in a humid-subtropical city at its greyest. CMA 1991–2020 at Xujiahui: January mean 5.4 °C, a few measured sunshine hours a day, damp in unheated corridors. Daylight around ten hours. The Huangpu is a working river. Evenings can be a family table if you protect them. The rubric does not mention the table.

THESIS

LINK is intergenerational maintenance with a delivery grade attached, not discovery. Going back is not tourism. It is a relationship that does not care about your transcript.

Published extras. LINK-V is lectures Jan–Apr 2027 + **HCMC 1–20 June 2027** — a LiA collision, not a backup. Track list is common (teams, design thinking, industry, AI). **No Shanghai partner list or project brief is published.** Health-adjacent projects, compulsory Mainland, and the T&N HK\$80k: **UNVERIFIED**. HKUWW interviews, if any, sit inside the immersion; video **UNVERIFIED**.

You already have Mainland rural in the archive (Gannan; Wu Zhi Qiao). LINK-S is urban industry — a different China. Useful for the trusted-interface thesis only if the HK team and Mainland partners are treated as a *seam*, not a startup demo.

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

The 12 credits are a decoy: real, GPA-exempt, academically easy. The human case is the kitchen. Fifty-five percent of the grade is execution. Grandparents are not in the rubric. If you want both, evenings are a second syllabus. The failure mode is blur — January remembered as weather. Keep a daily object (a sentence, a walk to a specific door) so it does not blur.

Shanghai is home. Traveler-provided; not identity drama; geography. The world not seen still has October, LiA, HKUWW, maybe NEWDAY 2027. This slot is the one that can still sit a grandson next to a demo day.

WHAT YOU WOULD ACTUALLY REMEMBER

A specific winter with specific people who will not be here forever. Industry visits. Wet cold. A table. Protect only the project and you remember a course. Protect only the table and you remember a holiday. The work is both.

WHAT IT COSTS THE REST OF THE DEGREE

First-Korea / Vilnius / January-Berlin / Chile in *this* gap. Those remain as later forms. You still need a written yes on Tung & Ngai compulsory Mainland, or another block will have to do that job. Flag LINK dates in the HKUWW application (opens 12 Oct). Ask IAO about criterion 3 *before* 4 Sep.

VERDICT

Enrol. Then send the three emails (IAO; Horizons; AASO/T&N). Do not apologise that it is not Nansen. Do not pretend that it is.

OPEN QUESTION

Do LINK-S and LINK-V differ in partners or briefs, and is there a form cap behind the Google Form?

Last line: Treat the project as fieldwork and the family table as the other course.

04 · Hanyang International Winter School · Session A

Stamp: LIVE ALTERNATE — first-Korea that fits

Dates: 26 Dec 2026 – 9 Jan 2027 · check-in 25 Dec · opening 26 Dec

Apply: 1 Sep – 22 Nov 2026 (A / A&B). Site update **1 Sep 2026**

Money (displayed 22 Aug 2026; provisional): app KRW 100,000 non-refundable; programme KRW 1,600,000; partner –200,000. Early-bird line still dated **1 Nov 2025**. Twin dorm KRW 450,000–500,000 for 16 nights (25 Dec–10 Jan); “rates may be adjusted.”

Course hook: tentative academic list includes **Nutrition and Disease Prevention** (ISS1212). Final list expected early October.

NEWDAY-likeness: 1 · **Fit:** 5 · **Memory:** 4 · **Meaning:** 2.5

SCENE

Seoul in late December: KMA 1991–2020 January mean **–2.0 °C**, dry, often clear, about 7.1 snowy days, daylight a little under ten hours. A Han River campus emptied of locals, international winter-school density, convenience stores, fried chicken at an hour when Shanghai grandparents are asleep. Opening ceremony. Club activities. “20 types of WINTER Tours,” their marketing. Their word: Edutainment.

THESIS

First-Korea is a real memory. It is also the most *replaceable* unseen-world on this list, because SKY summer schools will sell you the same campus in July.

SPECS

Session B’s apply-page year string is broken; calendar reading is OT 19 Jan 2027, classes from 20 Jan — after Sem 2 starts. Up to two courses, max 5 credits: one academic (3 credits, 09:00–15:00) plus elective. Ignore leftover “40% Active Partner Scholarship” copy on a general OIA page — it is not on the current winter tuition table. Whether HKU is a “partner university” for the –200,000 is **UNVERIFIED**.

Nutrition and Disease Prevention is a 3-credit survey title, not China CDC. Confirm the live list before calling this GHD.

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

Christmas Day check-in versus a Shanghai table is the actual decision, not “Korea versus China” in the abstract. Hanyang is the SKY campus whose dates respect 24 Dec wheels-up. Yonsei and Korea University start **22 Dec**, a full academic day — they are the same species with worse physics (sheet 13). You are not choosing a better university. You are choosing a calendar.

A professional international office can manufacture belonging: orientation videos, talent stage, commencement you did not need. That is not a failure. It is a product. NEWDAY manufactured argument. Do not confuse a full daysheet with a house.

WHAT YOU WOULD ACTUALLY REMEMBER

Hard air, early dark, neon, a dorm twin, a survey course, a city that is genuinely new. Ten years later the commencement will have dissolved. The first convenience-store night might not.

WHAT IT COSTS THE REST OF THE DEGREE

LINK-S: 12 credits, subsidy, grandparents, the only native-fit Mainland winter before LiA. You can still do Korea in a summer school later. You cannot later repurchase this particular December with these particular people at that particular table. SSE: do not spend it. IAO Zone 4 short-term scholarship scale (as of AY 2025-26) HK\$6,000 — winter 2026/27 registration dates **not posted**.

VERDICT

Take it only if you have already chosen first-Korea over family-and-credits. Re-read fees on **1 September**. Do not take it as a dialogue academy.

OPEN QUESTION

Is HKU a partner for the displayed –200,000, and does the 1 Sep sheet retire the 2025 early-bird line?

Last line: Seoul in December is a country you have not seen, sold in a format you have already understood.

05 · Vilnius · Lithuanian Language Winter Course

Stamp: LIVE ALTERNATE — only small-Europe complete fit

Dates: 4–15 Jan 2027

Money (published): €650 · 3 ECTS · 50 academic hours · register/pay by 20 Dec 2026 · repeat-student 10%

Levels: A1 to B1 · classes often 09:00–15:00 at Universiteto g. 5, then cultural lectures / weekday tours

Housing: self-arranged (page lists options; no guaranteed dorm scraped)

Visa note: winter-course students are **not** eligible for a national D visa via VU mediation. HKSAR Schengen short-stay is a separate question — confirm purpose-of-stay wording; do not invent visa-free days.

NEWDAY-likeness: 2 · **Fit:** 5 · **Memory:** 4.5 · **Meaning:** 1.5 · **GHD:** near zero

SCENE

A philology faculty in a UNESCO old town, river-bend brick Baroque, January mean about **−3.7 °C**, humidity 88%, **35.1 hours** of measured sunshine in the whole month — a little more than an hour of actual sun on an average January day. Calculated daylight around eight hours, less on New Year. Lakes described as almost always frozen from December to March. Grammar in the morning. Baltic dusk by mid-afternoon.

THESIS

English is the colonial language of winter schools. Lithuanian is not. Fifty hours of a language you will not need for GHD is a technology for paying attention.

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

This is the honest “world I have not seen” European play that **fits**. It is also the easiest option to remember later as “I took a random language.” Meaning score 1.5 is not an insult. It is the price of calendar-fit in a city IAO barely knows how to sell. You cannot later tell a selection panel this was “Baltic health systems” unless you actually go and look — and the course does not require that. If you take Vilnius, write yourself a second syllabus the host will not grade: one clinic door from the outside, one cemetery, one conversation that is not the classroom, one walk after 15:00 when the light is already failing. That is how a language course becomes a country.

NEWDAY-likeness 2 is the dark doing some of the landscape’s work without a dialogue academy. Do not take it to look busy.

WHAT YOU WOULD ACTUALLY REMEMBER

Courtyards, frozen river light, the humiliation of A1, a guided KGB Museum hour if you go, the specific boredom of self-housing in early January. High memory per euro *if* you like being slightly lost.

WHAT IT COSTS THE REST OF THE DEGREE

LINK-S, and any story in which this winter was Mainland fieldwork. Europe still exists for HKUWW. Two weeks of Lithuanian will not compound into China CDC. They might compound into a sentence about humility and attention, which is a NEWDAY sentence, not a GHD one.

VERDICT

Take it if memory > meaning, and if first-Baltics beats grandparents. Otherwise no.

OPEN QUESTION

Where will you actually sleep 3–16 January, and will that booking exist when you need it?

Last line: A small language in a dark capital is a way of forcing the month to be specific.

06 · HUWISU Term 1 · Berlin

Stamp: LIVE ALTERNATE — GHD classroom; a return

Dates (course catalogue, [huwisu.de](https://www.huwisu.de), 22 Aug 2026): subject courses 4–15 Jan 2027, 6 ECTS, €1,050

Named Term 1 hooks: Refugee Protection and Forced Migration; Green Cities and Humboldt's Cosmos of Nature; Berlin history / museums / memory

Misses: Term 2 18–29 Jan; German intensive 4–29 Jan

Housing: not packaged. January self-booking after Christmas is **operational risk**

NEWDAY-likeness: 2 · **Fit:** 4.5 · **Meaning:** 3.5 · **Memory:** 3

SCENE

You already have a World Health Summit 2025 memory of this city: plenary rooms, a badge, urban-health talk, October light. January is another film on the same streets. DWD 1991–2020 January mean **0.7 °C**, 52.6 hours of sunshine, daylight a little over eight hours. Christmas markets already down. Seminar rooms. A city that has had to operationalise the word *refugee*.

THESIS

“I have been to Berlin” is a category error. You have been to a *summit* in Berlin. January is the city without the lanyard. It is still a return, not a first.

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

Refugee Protection in this city is the most GHD-shaped European classroom that actually fits the window. Nutrition at Hanyang is a survey with a health title. Humboldt is a seminar in a polity that has had to mean the reading list. That is the meaning case. The memory case is weaker than Vilnius because the city slot is already occupied. World Health Summit 2027 is October-shaped (third-party listings; official 2027 dates not treated as confirmed here). January is not a summit add-on. Stale banners on the HUWISU page still mention older editions — trust the 2027 course rows, re-check in September.

WHAT YOU WOULD ACTUALLY REMEMBER

Dark residential streets, a museum without a queue, a seminar, the hassle of a flat. Or, if housing fails, a story about scrambling. The operational risk is the real antagonist, not the syllabus.

WHAT IT COSTS THE REST OF THE DEGREE

LINK-S. A first-country winter. You will still fly to Europe in other years if HKUWW happens. You will not get this particular January-Berlin seminar unless you take it, and you do not need it for the thesis if LINK and LiA and CHP do their jobs.

VERDICT

Best *GHD-shaped* European fit. Only if you want a Berlin seminar more than grandparents or first-Korea. Do not pick Term 2. Do not pick it to “do Europe.”

OPEN QUESTION

Can you actually house yourself in Berlin 3–16 January without turning the fortnight into logistics?

Last line: A return can be deeper than first-ness. It can also be a rerun. Only you know which.

07 · Tübingen T-IES · the cousin you cannot have

Stamp: COUSIN — dates lose

Dates: 4–29 Jan 2027 (arrival Mon 4; farewell Thu 28; departure Fri 29)

Money (published): €1,950 / €1,800 partner · **housing included** (youth hostel on the Neckar or host family) · city transport, courses, excursions, welcome/farewell. Not: visa, flights, insurance, most meals (hostel breakfast+dinner if in the youth hostel; host family breakfast)

Credits: 8 ECTS (subject 6 + German/intercultural/buddy 2) · max 45 participants

Tracks: (A) Europe, Memory, and Diversity; (B) **Human Rights and Migration in Europe**; (C) **Sustainability, Biodiversity, and Ethics in Europe** · plus German A1–A2

Quoted caution: “Participants in the Winter School will not be enrolled as students of the University of Tübingen.”

NEWDAY-likeness: 4.5 · **Fit:** 1 · **Meaning:** 4.5 · **Memory:** 4.5

SCENE

A Neckar university town. DWD 1991–2020 January daily mean **1.3 °C**, 60.8 hours of sunshine, daylight around eight and three-quarter hours. Hostel breakfasts. Host families who have done this for years. Damp-cold cobbles. Sustainability as recycling rules and a river, not a slide. Forty-five people, not a credit mill.

THESIS

This is the winter programme on the list that most nearly shares NEWDAY’s *architecture*: residential, small town, housing in the fee, tracks that are actually your subjects. The calendar does not share it. Fit 1.0 is not a rounding error. It is the first two weeks of GHD Year 2.

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

Naming Tübingen as the cousin is how you stop auditioning Paris, Vienna, Lille, and Tallinn for the same job. They are not the same job. Lille is a hotel. Tallinn has the GHD course titles and still runs to 29 Jan. univie starts 29 Jan. KEDGE 2027 is unpublished. Tübingen is the form. Keep the name. Do not force the window and then pretend the wall moved. SPH has not written an exception. You do not have one.

Early application “until mid-October” / accepted until 10 Dec 2026 if places remain (partner circular vs host page — re-read before any application you are not making this year).

WHAT IT COSTS THE REST OF THE DEGREE

Eighteen to twenty-nine January is teaching, not a gap. Missing it for a winter school is a faculty conversation, a possible leave of absence, and a story you would have to defend against LiA, HKUWW, and a 4.09 you did not need to gamble. Do not.

VERDICT

Do not enrol under the current window. Keep as the named cousin if a later January ever opens.

OPEN QUESTION

Would you actually want this in January 2028, or do you only want it because it looks like Lillehammer from a distance?

Last line: The list’s only small-town winter with a house in the fee lives in the wrong month. That is allowed to be the end of the sentence.

08 · Lille Winter · packaged Europe, six days over

Stamp: PACKAGE — dates lose

Dates: 6–23 Jan 2027 · apply 1 Sep – 15 Nov 2026 · payment with application · first-come

Money (published): €2,750 non-partner / €2,500 partner · hospitality: hotel near campus, double occupancy, weekday breakfast, lunch credit, metro pass, Bruges + Reims field trips, two group meals, 24/7 support, buddy system. Optional Fromelles & Ieper €100
2027 courses: morning French **or** Project Management in Europe (24h / 4 ECTS). Afternoon: French art & cinema; world-class art museums; diverse teams; sustainability-in-action **to be confirmed**. Plus 3h intercultural communication.

Trap: “Health & Wellness” on the generic blurb is **not** in the 2027 option list fetched 22 Aug 2026.

NEWDAY-likeness: 3.5 · **Fit:** 1.5 · **Memory:** 4

SCENE

French Flanders in January: Lesquin 1991–2020 mean **4.1 °C**, grey and wet more often than white, daylight around eight and a half hours. A hotel twin. A buddy. A bus to Bruges, a bus to Reims. Canal light at 16:30. Being well taken care of.

THESIS

Lille manufactures belonging. NEWDAY manufactured argument. Easy Europe is not nothing, and it is not a campfire.

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

This is the professionally wrapped version of a hunger you already understand. The overrun is six days of Sem 2. The health line is bait from a generic page. If a later January ever opens, Tübingen is still the truer cousin; Lille is the easier one. Do not split the difference by pretending 18–23 Jan is “add/drop so it is fine” without SPH in writing.

VERDICT

Do not force it into 17 Jan. If you ever extend the window, this is the easy Europe.

OPEN QUESTION

Is HKU a partner for the €250 discount, and is sustainability-in-action actually confirmed for 2027?

Last line: A hotel that solves loneliness is a different good from a house that stages a disagreement.

09 · Chile · the craving and the product

Stamp: CRAVING ≠ PRODUCT

The product: TFAS Santiago, 9–23 Jan 2027, Universidad de los Andes, 6 ECTS / 3 US cr

Money (published): USD 2,950 — tuition, Hotel Diego de Velázquez (Providencia, double, assigned international roommate), breakfast daily, weekday lunch, campus bus to UANDES. Not included: long-haul, dinners, weekend lunches, extra travel.

Scholarships: TFAS says more than 90% of admitted students receive some; **amount UNVERIFIED** until an offer.

Apply: early 16 Aug 2026 **already passed** · final **20 Sep 2026, 23:59 EST**

Fit: 1.5 (overruns Sem 2 by six days) · **NEWDAY-likeness:** 1.5 (residential cohort, wrong house)

SCENE

January in the Mapocho valley is not winter. DMC 1991–2020 at Pudahuel: January mean **21.4 °C**, mean maximum **30.2 °C**, **0.3 mm** rain, **366 hours** of sunshine, daylight about fourteen hours. Andes on the skyline on a clear day. A private bus from a Providencia hotel to a campus. A lecture titled, on their sample schedule, **“Marxism, Socialism, Liberalism, and the Totalitarian Impulse.”** Faculty bios include the Mont Pelerin Society, Austrian economics, the Foundation for Economic Education. This is not a hidden bias. It is the product. Valparaíso, Congress, Neruda’s La Sebastiana, an asado — named, real, and still not the Atacama.

THESIS

You are allowed to want Chile. TFAS is not how you buy Chile. LiA is not how you buy Chile either. Those are three objects. Wanting the Andes from Hong Kong is a legitimate maximand. Paying USD 2,950 to sit a classical-liberal seminar in a hotel, then trying to staple nature onto the fortnight before it, is how a craving gets captured by a programme.

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

NEWDAY’s mechanism was a residential cohort in a house. TFAS copied the *mechanism* (roommate, bus, cohort, field day) into a different *house* (political economy of a “free society,” Chile as market-economy illustration). Miss Lillehammer and you will get the bus, not the argument you meant.

LiA (Medellín / Mexico City, planned summer 2027) does **not** scratch Patagonia, Atacama, or southern-summer Andes. The cost of two trans-Pacific Latin American trips in one degree year is attention, money, and SSE conservation — not a claim that Mexico is Chile. Do not twin them. Do not pretend they do not compete.

If you add “1–2 weeks before TFAS to see the rest of the country”: last paper 23 Dec unless confirmed earlier; **no nonstop** HKG–SCL (fastest connections advertised ~24h on an Aug 2026 aggregator snapshot — **not** a January fare); on the ground ~26 Dec – 8 Jan is **one** region; TFAS 9–23 Jan; Sem 2 teaching **18 Jan** while you are still in class in Chile; LINK-S abandoned. Chile is more than 4,000 km long. Ten days is a hub, not a country. Sheet 10.

WHAT YOU WOULD ACTUALLY REMEMBER, IF YOU TAKE TFAS

Providencia hotel, campus bus, a point-of-view classroom, Valparaíso, heat in your winter. Andes as backdrop to a syllabus. Fine if the syllabus is the point. Wrong if you wanted silence and wind.

WHAT IT COSTS THE REST OF THE DEGREE

LINK-S. First week of Sem 2. A second Americas long-haul before LiA. SSE — **do not**. IAO Zone 1 scale HK\$14,000 as of AY 2025-26; winter registration not posted; largest-single-award rule still applies.

VERDICT

Do not take TFAS as the way to see Chile. If the craving is landscape, take a nature-only window (sheet 10) or take Chile later, not a seminar that overruns Sem 2. If the craving is specifically this argument (classical liberalism in Chile), say that out loud and then decide whether 18–23 Jan is a price you will still pay in April. This brief’s default remains no.

OPEN QUESTION

Is the hunger Chile, or is it “I have not been to the southern hemisphere in summer, and TFAS is the row on the list”?

Last line: A residential cohort is a mechanism. The house it sits in is the whole decision.

10 • Chile • nature, trains, cars, and money without a fake total

Stamp: LOGISTICS — one region, or don't go

Access: 22 Aug 2026

Visa (HKSAR passport): HK Immigration's visa-free list names **Chile, 90 days**. Confirm with the Consulate General of Chile in Hong Kong before buying tickets. Do not treat a list as a boarding pass.

Season: January is southern-summer high season — beds and park camps sell.

SCENE

From Hong Kong, Chile is one of the long hauls into someone else's high summer. The Andes do a thing the Lion Rock does not. That uniqueness is real. It does not require a UANDES lecture.

THESIS

In this window you can do **one** Chilean nature region well, or two badly, or TFAS-plus-a-pre-trip that overruns Sem 2. You cannot do "the rest of the country." Fly to a hub, then use the local tool.

HOW THE COUNTRY IS ACTUALLY JOINED

REGION	HUB	DURATION (PUBLISHED APPROX.)	LOCAL TOOL
Atacama	Calama (CJC)	LATAM SCL-CJC ~2h07-2h10	Transfer to San Pedro; tours; car optional
Lake District	Puerto Montt (PMC)	SKY SCL-PMC ~1h45	Rental car is the product (PMC loop)
Torres del Paine	Punta Arenas (PUQ)	SKY SCL-PUQ ~3h30	Bus to Puerto Natales, then park bus
Central valley	EFE trains	Santiago-Chillán; lakes local	Not Atacama. Not Magallanes

EFE (22 Aug 2026) is Chillán, Llanquihue–Puerto Montt, Araucanía, commuter/wine-country. Summer 2026 tourist extras (incl. Santiago–Temuco night train); **2027 unpublished. No passenger train to Calama or Punta Arenas**. A car belongs in the Lakes, not as SCL-to-Patagonia. The W is not a car.

Paine is a booking problem first. CONAF from **1 May 2026**: daily pass or 2+ days (max 10 consecutive), **pasesparques.cl**. A 2026 tariff page lists **CLP 32,400 / 48,500** in a higher band but heads both tables "Visitante Nacional" — **category UNVERIFIED**. W nights: Vertice + Las Torres Patagonia (ex-Fantástico Sur). January camps **sell out**; a late-August January W is already late. If camps are gone, Patagonia remaining is a day-hike. Atacama and the Lakes still work.

MONEY (STRUCTURE, NOT A TOTAL)

No household figures. No fake HKD sum. **A. Long-haul HKG–SCL** — fare **UNVERIFIED**; no nonstop; ~24h advertised (Aug 2026 snapshot, not a Jan 2027 ticket); high season; **usually dominates**. **B. TFAS if taken** — **USD 2,950** published; dinners extra. **C. One-region nature** — domestic fares not quoted (SKY "from USD 59" SCL–PUQ on access was **March**). CONAF is small next to beds/tours; a packaged W can make C large. **Do not spend SSE**. Zone 1 scale HK\$14,000 as of AY 2025-26; winter registration not posted.

THREE ITINERARIES

1. **Nature-only, back for Sem 2** — fly 24 Dec; one region; sit 18 Jan. Atacama or Lakes. **The only Chile that fits**. Kills LINK-S.
2. **TFAS + prologue** — 26 Dec–8 Jan one region; 9–23 Jan seminar. Misses 18–23 Jan teaching. Nature is a trailer.
3. **Chile later** — keep LINK-S. January 2027 is not the last southern summer of your life.

VERDICT

If the craving is landscape: **itinerary 1 or 3**, not 2. If you insist on 2, you are buying a classroom with a nature trailer, and you should say that. Default of this pack remains LINK-S; Chile is a written exception, not a vibe.

OPEN QUESTION

Can you name the region in one word — Atacama, Lakes, or Paine — without adding "and the rest"?

Last line: Chile is long the way a country is long, not the way a winter school is long. Pick a verb (walk, drive, stare at salt) and a hub. Leave the rest for a life that still has summers.

11 · Money physics · do not invent a household

Stamp: CONSTRAINTS

Plane: operator. No private figures.

THESIS

The expensive mistake on this list is not Yonsei tuition. It is spending **SSE**, or assuming **Tung & Ngai's HK\$80,000** will quietly pay LINK, or treating a host fee as the trip.

PUBLISHED MECHANICS (ACCESSED 22 AUG 2026)

SSE / SSEBR (short-term, AY2026-27 page). Eligible window 1 Sep 2026 – 31 Aug 2027. Apply within 1 month of completion. SSE: **once per UG, irrespective of amount**; means-tested (SFO or CSSA). Asia destination row HK\$3,000; 14–28 days HK\$6,000. SSEBR Asia **excludes Mainland, Taiwan, Macao**. Non-means-tested SSEBR: once, lifetime cap HK\$18,000. Same destination cannot be paid twice across schemes. University **adjusts downward** if other subsidy exists — MicroBit HK\$5,000 is therefore not a clean add-on to a government ceiling. Over-180-days SSE band HK\$45,000 before destination — that is the year-long exchange. **Keep the once.**

MES (non-means-tested, Mainland only). ≥3 days, **once** per UG, reimbursement. Arithmetic for 14–28 days: destination HK\$900 + duration HK\$1,800 = **HK\$2,700** ceiling, then downward adjustment. Catch: China Vision page still stated eligible period **1 Sep 2025 – 31 Aug 2026**. Confirm **2026-27** before treating LINK-S as eligible. Local and non-local students eligible on that page — unlike SSE.

IAO short-term scholarships. In-person, ≥2 weeks, GPA ≥2.0. **Largest-single-award** across the UG career; a second award can claw back the first. Scale as of AY 2025-26: Zone 4 Japan/Korea HK\$6,000; Zone 5 Mainland outside Guangdong HK\$5,000; Zone 1 Europe/US/Chile HK\$14,000; Zone 2 Australia HK\$13,000. Winter 2026/27 registration **not posted**. Last updated 9 Sep 2025.

LINK cash in. HK\$5,000 each; HK\$10,000 MicroBit after a pass for high achievers (not guaranteed).

T&N HK\$80k. Shared compulsory-Mainland + optional-international cap. **Not assumed** to fund LINK. Compulsory-Mainland via LINK: **UNVERIFIED**.

Host fees stay in original currency. No FX conversions in this pack.

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

A Recognised winter school is one where you pay the host. LINK is one where HKU already built the subsidy into the product. Fudan in your home city asks CNY 16,200–18,000 plus self-housing to *not* get 12 HKU credits. That is prestige-hunger wearing a classroom. Chile's published line (USD 2,950) is not the trip; the unpublished long-haul is.

VERDICT

Do not spend SSE. Confirm MES year. Confirm T&N in writing. Do not subtract IAO's advertised UIBE HK\$4,000 until IAO writes how it is applied.

OPEN QUESTION

Does the 2026-27 MES window exist, and does LINK-S debit the Foundation cap?

Last line: The once-per-degree pots are how winter looks cheap while stealing a later year.

12 · HKUWW · does winter burn the slot?

Stamp: EMAIL BEFORE 4 SEP

Clause (IAO, 2027/28): “Not joined any previous semester exchange programmes or special visiting programmes organised by IAO, faculties or departments.”

Apply: 12 Oct – 11 Dec 2026 · interviews late Dec / mid-Jan *if applicable* · results 5 Feb 2027

THESIS

Best reading: **no, winter does not burn HKUWW**. Residual: “special visiting” is undefined. Being wrong costs the only slot.

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

LINK is Horizons, not IAO/faculty/department. Shape: HKU course plus field component, not a semester at a host. Recognised winters sit under Short-term Study, “not available on an exchange basis” unless noted. That is the legalistic comfort. The interviews, if they happen, sit **inside LINK-S**. The 11 Dec deadline does not. Video format is **UNVERIFIED**. Flag travel dates *in the application* when it opens. Draft the 100-word statement in October reading week, not in a Shanghai Airbnb on 10 December.

VERDICT

One email to the IAO goabroad inbox before 4 Sep: (a) criterion 3 for LINK and for a registered Recognised winter programme; (b) video interviews from Shanghai. Enrol in LINK-S anyway unless that email comes back as a disaster — missing 4 Sep is worse than adding/dropping later.

OPEN QUESTION

Will IAO put “special visiting” in a sentence you can keep?

Last line: The residual risk is real. The unsent email is the only way it stays residual.

13 · Closed · Yonsei WAY and Korea University IWC

Stamp: CLOSED under the stated window

Yonsei WAY: classes **22 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027**. Quote: “**December 22 is a full academic day.**” App KRW 100,000; 1 course KRW 1,870,000 (early 1,590,000). Leaflet (notice 14 Aug 2026): **Human Body, Diseases, and Research**; Korean Food and Culture. On-campus housing: early-bird acceptees only. Christmas and New Year off; makeup 2 Jan. App opens 3 Sep.

KU IWC: 3-week **22 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027**; 4-week to **18 Jan 2027** (Sem 2 collision). App KRW 100,000; 1 course KRW 1,790,000; early –100,000 by 30 Sep. Dorm example: International House 3-week single KRW 831,400 including bedding KRW 41,000.

THESIS

Prestige is a solvent for calendar physics. It should not be. Missing two teaching days of a three-week course is not a rounding error. Hanyang Session A is the same species with dates that fit.

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

Human Body, Diseases, and Research sounds GHD and is probably a pre-med survey. Clinical/body is not CHP and not China CDC. Do not pick KU over Yonsei on QS. Pick Hanyang over both on 24 Dec. If you can sit 22–23 Dec in Seoul because your last paper ended early, Yonsei becomes a real option — under the **stated** window, it is a compromise. 4-week KU is a miss even then.

VERDICT

Closed unless last paper is genuinely early *and* you accept the species (SKY credit mill). Otherwise Hanyang A or nothing Korean.

Last line: The strongest SKY brand on the list has the worst first-day physics for a 24 December departure.

14 · Closed · Fudan International Winter Session

Stamp: CLOSED as a LINK substitute

Dates: 21 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027 · registration 19 Dec · orientation 20 Dec (inside HKU exams)

Money: CNY 400 application + **18,000** tuition (**16,200** early bird). Housing **not** included. Early-bird apply **31 Aug 2026 11:00 BJT**; pay **4 Sep 11:00**. Personal-withdrawal early-bird **non-refundable**.

Chinese-citizen deadline 23 Nov; non-Chinese 9 Nov.

THESIS

Paying visiting-student tuition to sit a classroom in the city where you can be a grandson, while declining 12 HKU credits and a published subsidy, is how prestige-hunger disguises itself as “being in Shanghai academically.” LINK already puts you in Shanghai academically.

THE INSIGHT THAT IS NOT ON THE BROCHURE

Early-bird pay **4 Sep** is the same calendar day LINK Round 2 closes. That is a designed collision: a non-refundable Fudan wire the afternoon you were supposed to still be free to choose LINK. Do not pay unless Fudan-over-LINK is already a real decision. Fudan wins only if a specific Fudan transcript line is the point. English classroom China-economy/AI/society is not a substitute for a 12-credit HKU project course, and it is a worse calendar.

VERDICT

No, unless a named Fudan course is the whole reason. Do not early-bird on a whim.

Last line: Same city, worse physics, more cash out, fewer HKU credits. That is not a sleeper hit.

15 · Closed · pathways that look like fits

Virginia Tech Winter Session. Marketing 26 Dec 2026 – 16 Jan 2027; catalog: virtual from 28 Dec, residential Blacksburg **4–15 Jan**, exam 16 Jan. Visiting apply by **15 Dec**, US\$25. Offices closed **24–31 Dec**. No published visiting-student winter dorm. Visiting page does **not** mention I-20/DS-2019 for a three-week visitor. Tuition PDF 404 this access. Blacksburg in January (NOAA 1991–2020 mean about **−0.1 °C**, January snow in the record) would be a real American campus-town memory. It is also a visa-and-housing project. **Do not build January around VT** unless Cranwell and the winter office write visa, housing, and tuition in one email.

Hanyang Internship (CRCC Asia). 14 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027, 8 hours/day, advised arrival 11–13 Dec. Starts *inside* assessment. Must also register for one Hanyang **online** course. Intern KRW **UNVERIFIED**. Health not named on the internship intro. Only if last paper is early *and* you want labour. Otherwise no.

TU Berlin Term 2. Overview 5–15 Jan 2027, 3 ECTS; some course pages still print 5–29 Jan / 6 ECTS. Student 2-week fee **€1,050**. Early-bird −€100 by 1 Oct 2026. STEM / Industry 5.0, not dialogue. **Conditional FIT** only after a *named* course is confirmed in writing. Not NEWDAY. Not a reason to skip LINK.

LINK-V, HCMC, 1–20 June 2027. Not a winter programme. Named so you do not “save LINK for summer.” Summer is LiA. The mind wants a backup. The backup is a collision.

Last line: A calendar that rhymes with your gap is not a pathway. Visa, housing, and the rest of the degree still have to exist.

16 · Graveyard · so you do not reopen them

Each row is a *why*, not a *maybe*.

PROGRAMME	WHY IT IS DEAD FOR THIS WINDOW
Tallinn 11–29 Jan 2027	Cruellest miss: “Unique. Small. Challenging,” plus Design of Digital Services for Health Behaviour Change and Refugee Studies — GHD-adjacent — and it still overruns Sem 2. Hostel extra. If you ever get a later January, re-read this row before Lille
Deakin ASSS 3–23 Jan 2027	AUD 5,200 all-in (AIX290, on-campus housing, airport pickup, welcome dinner, surf day). Southern summer, first-Australia memory, packaged. Overruns six days. Direct crawl 403 this access — dates/fee from public page text. Miss unless Sem 2 moves
Sophia January	2027 unpublished. 2026 on-campus 7–28 Jan already overran 17 Jan. Tokyo would be first-Japan. Watch Piloti; do not plan from 2026
TUJP Sendai	W1 4–21 Dec 2026 (too early; disaster-prevention / earthquake memorials are actually GHD-adjacent, wrong month). W2 14–29 Jan 2027 (too late). A good programme in a bad slot
KEDGE Paris	2027 unpublished / timed out. 2026 ran 12–23 Jan. Business school, self-housing. Miss-shaped
univie: winter	29 Jan – 12 Feb 2027 . After Sem 2 is underway. Miss
UIBE SSAP	Beijing, not Shanghai. In-person 19 Dec 2026 – 8 Jan 2027. Credit mill. IAO HK\$4,000 discount UNVERIFIED until written. Overlaps LINK. Wrong city for grandparents
Jinan winter	2026/27 tab not up. Last published winter 15 Dec 2025 – 16 Jan 2026. Unpublished
HUWISU Term 2 / German	Hits Sem 2
TU Berlin on-campus banner	5–29 Jan — miss except the conditional 2-week slice

Last line: Most of the list is a graveyard with excellent lighting. Do not mourn a date that was never yours.

17 · This week · before 4 September

1. **Enrol in LINK-S** unless you have already written the sentence that first-ness beats family-and-credits. The form does not prevent later add/drop. Missing 4 Sep prevents joining.
2. **Email IAO** (goabroad inbox on the HKUWW page): criterion 3 + video interviews from Shanghai.
3. **Email Horizons LINK**: Shanghai vs HCMC briefs, form cap, health-adjacent projects.
4. **Email AASO / Tung & Ngai**: does a 3-week Horizons Mainland course satisfy compulsory Mainland, and does it debit the HK\$80k?
5. **Do not** submit Fudan early-bird (31 Aug / 4 Sep) unless Fudan-over-LINK is real. Non-refundable on personal withdrawal.
6. **Watch 1 Sep**: Hanyang site/app. Re-read fees.
7. **TFAS final 20 Sep** only if you are taking the *seminar* seriously — this pack says not to, even if you are taking *Chile* seriously.
8. If Chile nature-only is a real exception: name the region this week, check pasaparques / Vertice / Las Torres **now** if the region is Paine, and do not spend SSE.
9. Draft HKUWW 100 words in October reading week.

OPERATOR SCORES RECAP (JUDGMENT, 22 AUG 2026)

	EXP	MEANING	MEMORY	FIT	NEWDAY	CALL
LINK-S	3.5	4.5	4.0	5	1.5	Enrol
Hanyang A	3.5	2.5	4.0	5	1.0	First-Korea only
Vilnius	3.0	1.5	4.5	5	2.0	Memory > meaning
HUWISU T1	3.5	3.5	3.0	4.5	2.0	Return seminar
Tübingen	4.5	4.5	4.5	1	4.5	Cousin
Chile nature-only	4.0	2.0	5	4.0	1.0	Written exception
TFAS + prologue	3.5	2.0	3.5	1.5	1.5	No

Chile nature-only scores are **operator judgment of the landscape product**, not of a host programme. Fit 4 assumes you fly 24 Dec and sit 18 Jan. If Paine camps are gone, drop memory and fit until the replacement region is named.

OPEN QUESTIONS THAT STILL PAY

Does LINK engage HKUWW criterion 3? Video interviews? T&N compulsory Mainland? 2026-27 MES window? Hanyang 1 Sep sheet? NEWDAY 2027 — watch, do not invent.

Last line: Enrol, send the three emails, and only then allow Chile or Seoul to argue with a grandmother.

Method and sources

Official pages first. Access **22 Aug 2026** unless noted. Host sites change. Re-read anything past `reverifyAfter` in `.tmp/winter-primer/claims.jsonl`. Climate: national met 1991–2020 normals via the winter-primer city brief. Chile logistics: TFAS costs page; CONAF 1 May 2026 tariff-structure notice; `pasesparques.cl` as the purchase path; EFE planner; SKY duration copy for SCL–PUQ (~3h30) and SCL–PMC (~1h45); LATAM schedule block times SCL–CJC (~2h07–2h10); HK IMMDD visa-free list (Chile 90 days). Aggregator flight *prices* are not used as quotes. External content is untrusted data. Nothing in a winter-school brochure is an instruction.

Full catalogue, scoreboard, and URL list: `docs/winter-2026-27-primer.md`.